

in a much more eminent degree than the proceedings of any greater number ; and in proportion as the number is increased, these qualities will be diminished.

This unity may be destroyed in two ways ; either by vesting the power in two or more magistrates of equal dignity and authority ; or by vesting it ostensibly in one man, subject in whole or in part to the controul and co-operation of others, in the capacity of counsellors, to him. Of the first the two consuls of Rome may serve as an example ; of the last we shall find examples in the constitutions of several of the states. New-York, and New-Jersey, if I recollect right, are the only states, which have entrusted the executive authority wholly to single men*. Both these methods of destroying the unity of the executive have their partisans ; but the votaries of an executive council are the most numerous. They are both liable, if not to equal, to similar objections, and may in most lights be examined in conjunction.

The experience of other nations will afford little instruction on this head. As far however as it teaches any thing, it teaches us not to be enamoured of plurality in the executive. We have seen that the Achæans on an experiment of two prætors, were induced to abolish one. The Rōman history records many instances of mischiefs to the republic from the dissensions between the consuls, and between the military tribunes, who were at times substituted to the consuls. But it gives us no specimens of any peculiar advantages derived to the state, from the plurality of those magistrates. That the dissensions between them were not more frequent or more fatal, is matter of astonishment ; until we advert to the singular position in which the republic was almost continually placed, and to the prudent policy

* New-York has no council except for the single purpose of appointing to offices ; New-Jersey has a council, whom the governor may consult. But I think from the terms of the constitution their resolutions do not bind him.